

- (a) Blogger: to be able to easily publish to your Blogger blog.
- (b) Gmail: which shows you your Gmails at a glance.
- (c) Search History: which shows you what you've been searching for over the past few days. Not recommended if you share your Mac with someone, but that's unlikely, we suppose.

- 7. Google Ride Finder: It's US-based.
- 8. Google Suggest in Japanese: Again, none of us here are Berlitz fans, so we couldn't figure out what was on the page. Sorry!
- 9. Froogle Mobile US | Froogle Mobile UK, because we aren't in either of these countries.
- 10. Google Notebook, because this will be discussed under Google Extensions for Firefox.
- 11. Google Suggest, since it's now part of the Google Toolbar—which has been talked about elsewhere in this book.

So here's what this section will talk about, in alphabetical order:

- 1. *Accessible Search*
- 2. *Google Extensions for Firefox*
- 3. *Google Music Trends*
- 4. *Google Page Creator*
- 5. *Google Related Links*
- 6. *Google Sets*
- 7. *Google Trends*
- 8. *Google Web Accelerator*

4.1 Accessible Search

(<http://labs.google.com/accessible/>)

This is a page at which you perform regular Google searches, but the results are different—more geared towards accessibility by “the blind and visually impaired.”

Google's intention and methodology here is the following: it examines the HTML markup on a page, and prioritises pages that “few visual distractions, and pages that are likely to render well with images turned off.” Also, Google here takes into account factors such as “a given page's simplicity, how much visual imagery it carries, and whether or not its primary purpose is immediately viable with keyboard navigation.”

The first thing we must ask is, how are the ~blind~ helped? Then, how many pages have text-to-speech engines associated? If one is blind or visually impaired, you probably have a text-to-speech program installed anyway, in which case, what function does Accessible Search perform?

The results are indeed very different. For example, many searches bring up the Wikipedia entry as the first result. Then, a search for “York” brought up the first result as a page that had an “accessibility” link, clicking on which we got the following: “All text on this site is set in a relatively-sized font. You can resize the text easily from within your browser. You can also change the font, font colour and background colour.” The second result, too, had an Accessibility link: this included the capability to use keyboard shortcuts to navigate the site.

Most importantly, most results pages are low-graphics. We turned off images in our browser, and found that the pages encountered were pretty presentable.

But then, if you're visually impaired, just ignore the images—why restrict your search options?

Overall, this is not yet worth a try for the visually-impaired, and certainly not for the blind. There is one use we can think of for the site, though: if you're on dial-up and are a frequent Googler, use Accessible Search and turn off images to find pages that are low-graphics! If you use the regular Google, many pages look crippled—not so with the search results that come up here. You may not come up with the —most— relevant search results, but when we tried it,